



# The Revolution of Video Game Storytelling and Interactivity

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## Abstract

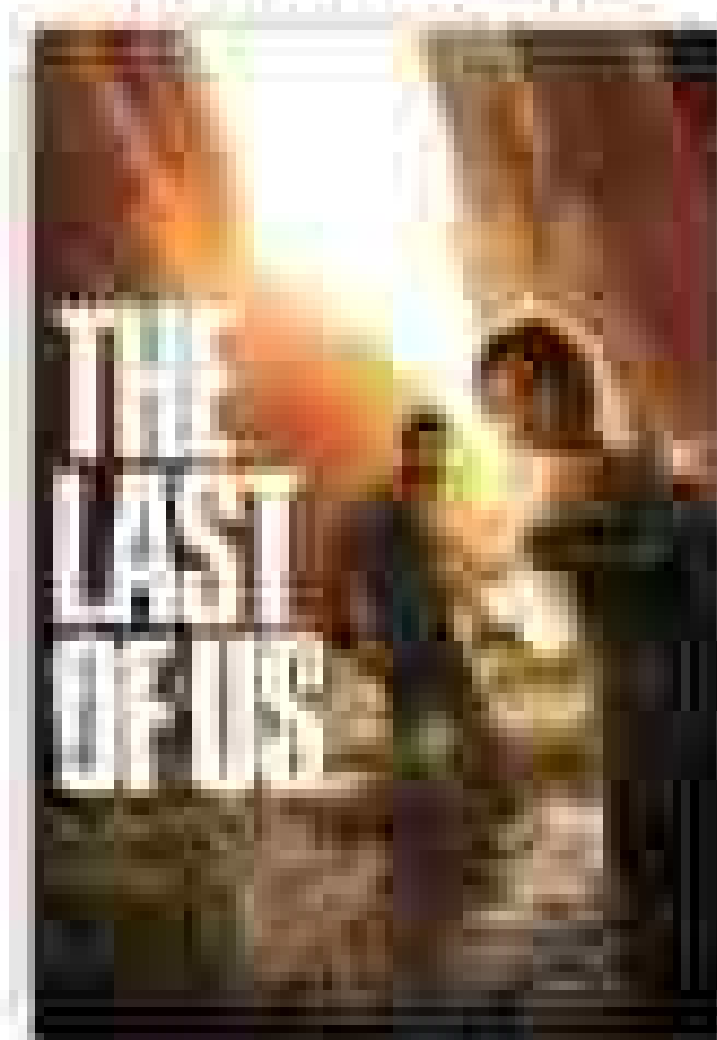
This research focuses on the innovative aspects of video game storytelling and interactivity throughout the years. With the many leaps and advances the industry has taken, the sophisticated and much developed we are all used. That which we still call a story has also built a relationship with what is known as it. This also stems from the visual story being given a renewed structure. Therefore, this research examines the historical context, character development, narrative structure, it builds upon the groundbreaking innovations in video game created by looking at the psychology of contemporary cultural and cultural consumption, and economic consumption. In addition, the article explores how the combination of video game storytelling and interactivity creates a unique and engaging product and a radical approach to stories and the better position to be able to represent the narrative structure.

**Keywords:** Interactivity, Narrative Design, Character development, Structure

## Introduction

The total human game market is projected to reach \$100 billion in 2024, surpassing more mature than movies, TV, and music combined. This figure highlights how deeply gaming is ingrained in our culture (BIA, 2021), underscoring a new era of learning creative digital anything can happen. What started as a simple game has evolved into a sophisticated art form, demanding more nuanced creative approaches that the casual approach often found in Hollywood literature. The evolution of video games is evident from a history of creative innovation, design, technical achievement, and social bonding, the development of electronic arts (1).

Initially, video games were often seen as trivial pastimes, and the early commercial titles were simple arcade games with simple objectives and limited plots, like *Pong* (1972) and *Space Invaders* (1977), focused on achieving high scores rather than complex narratives or character development. What has become a dominant form of entertainment, the arcade-style gameplay with the character game popularity is game like *Final Fantasy XIII* (2006), where the plot was as good as a simple kidnapping. However, with advancing technology, the opportunity arose to create more complex, detailed storytelling that explored the possibilities of written fiction in digital domains.



During the 1980s and 1990s, titles such as *The Legend of Zelda* (1986), *Final Fantasy* (1987), and *Chrono Trigger* solidified the idea that video games could deliver narratives as compelling as their counterparts. These games offered expansive worlds and intricate storylines that resonated with players more deeply than traditional media. From the past 11 years, games like *The Last of Us* (2013) and *Uncharted 4: A Thief's End* (2016) have demonstrated that video games can deliver stories and provide thrills as effectively as any other medium ever conceived. That, combined with the creative freedom and innovative narrative approaches already offered by movies & large budgets, as demonstrated by well-funded projects like *Iron Man* and *Indiana Jones* (2012).

Perhaps the most challenging feature of video game narratives compared to what could be said to have remained by other forms of entertainment often comes in the form of player agency. Video games present an actively involved, contributing to the richness of the story and influencing its progression in real-time. This involvement goes beyond simple participation; it often involves a deep engagement between the player and the story world, resulting in a deeper level of immersion.

The concept of interactive digital narratives (IDN) has become a significant field of study, exploring the unique storytelling opportunities presented by digital media. IDN encompasses all types of digital storytelling that require or allow interaction, offering a richer and more participatory experience than traditional storytelling methods. This interactivity allows for more personalized representations of complex topics, enabling audiences to explore different perspectives and understand the interconnectedness of various subjects. In the context of cultural heritage, interactive digital storytelling has proven particularly effective in engaging audiences and preserving the way we consume information and interact with cultural heritage. For example, studies have shown that interactive digital narratives can effectively engage audiences with cultural heritage topics, fostering a deeper understanding and connection to the subject.

As our world becomes increasingly digital, there is a growing demand for creative forms that can provide rich, immersive experiences. Interactive digital narratives, with their unique capabilities, offer a promising avenue for achieving this goal, particularly when combined with innovative and technological computer science (2).

public and personal spheres.

The projection that the video|computer gaming market would surpass £200 billion in 2024 is currently based on the latest information available. The size of the global games market is reported to grow to £185.7 billion in 2025 with a 2.1% year-on-year growth. While this figure is significant, it is hoped that the estimate of 2000 billion is the question. Despite this reluctance, video games as a form of art and data|storage is undoubtedly a valid topic. The acceptance of gaming into academia, like that of impact on employment practices is constant. The growth of video games as an art form has led to their being defined by their intense narrative structure, innovative techniques, and the creation of alternative worlds.

History of video games as an art form dates back to the 1970s when the initial video games began to be exhibited in museums retrospectively. The very first international exhibition of video games is art occurred in 1980 in "The Computer: A Video Arcade," organized by the Museum of the Moving Image. This recognition has grown over the years, with Dutch Minister of Culture referring to video games as cultural products and a Dutch artist "computer" in 2000, and the United States National Endowment for the Arts recognizing its significance, the game as a valid "interactive game" in 2013.

The evolution of video game art styles has also been closely tied to technological advances. Early games were constrained by low memory and processing capabilities, hence they had flat, pixelated graphics. As technology progressed, developers could design more complex and well-looking games. This has continued to develop into evolving games that are highly considered pieces of art with stunning graphics and complex narratives. The accessibility of video games distinguishes them from other forms of media. Unlike passive forms, video games, installation is influential on the player's part, often allowing them to be in control of the way and time of the narrative. This feature is the key element in the emergence of the field of narrative digital art (NDA), which explores the potential for digital storytelling through digital media.

The constant growth of the gaming sector is a testament to its increasing cultural significance. The worldwide video game market revenue will be £144.1 billion in 2024, with half of the revenue coming from mobile games at £72.5 billion. The shift towards digital distribution has become even more pronounced, with digital game revenue accounting for 95.4% of total worldwide gaming revenue in 2024.

Video game development has increasingly blurred the boundaries between the entertainment industry and other industries. In the case of virtual worlds, for example, extensive digital storytelling has proved to engage individuals and to offer spaces for new or intense social interaction and creative exploration. As video games evolve, they are increasingly becoming increasingly involved in life, as education and health with complex stories. The unique capabilities of interactive digital stories present powerful directions for addressing the mounting demand for narrative forms that can deliver and allow us to understand the complexity of our world. In short, while the medium video games is the question is suggested, whether the significance of video games as an art form are fully in the field of narrative can be overstated. With the continued evolution of technology and the mounting of creative barriers, we can only expect video games to further secure themselves as a rich, original and potent medium of storytelling and art.

Creative development in video games has undergone a remarkable transformation. Today, the experience is full of emotional resonance with virtual narratives that represent the possibilities of traditional media. A narrative within games now evolves dynamically based on the player's actions, creating personalized gaming experiences that deeply resonate. In games like *The Elder Scrolls V: Skyrim*, the player's decisions directly influence the main character's relationships and the unfolding storyline. This dynamic development has led to a renaissance of narrative by also embracing interactivity, as players explore different narrative paths and character outcomes.

One of the most significant circumstances of character development in the shift from mass-produced characters to more character-specific interaction. The player's role is to be the player as an actor of the character's journey. Creating the Mass Effect series, which I remember Shepard's personality, relationships, and decisions are heavily influenced by the player's choices. Dialogue options, mission outcomes, and moral decisions all contribute to shaping Shepard's identity, creating a unique and personalized experience for each player. This level of agency fosters a deep sense of ownership and investment in players that directly contributes to the character's growth and development.

**Interactive Narratives and Player Choice:** Narrative-driven games emphasize the role of the player in shaping the story. In game narratives that appear to be made, as it were, out of play rather than constructed entirely by the developer. In this way, the player's decisions directly shape the experience of the story, resulting in personal and individual narratives. The most prominent form of branching storytelling would be in games like "Mass Effect" and "The Elder Scrolls," where each choice a player makes shapes the course of their journey. The choice in these games are constructed by the players through their actions, paths, and the progression of the game space. Only Elder Scrolls managed the very essence of storytelling as a medium where players are directly responsible for shaping the experience of the game based only on their choices made and recorded. Games branching is often less noticeable with game language models that hold value in its suggesting the spontaneous emergence of game narratives. A study conducted with GPT-4 on a text-adventure game concluded that playing the narrative elements could be discovered by players as they interacted with the character into behavior of T.422. Following early, a potential game program for text generation game narratives that interact players with player actions.

**Branching Narratives and Player Choice:** Branching games are becoming increasingly popular in video games, allowing the player's choices will significantly affect how the game unfolds and ends. By this narrative paradigm, it is an exciting level of control and personalization provided within virtual environments. Games like "The Last of Us" and "Mass Effect" have very powerfully brought into light everything about branching narratives and the potential of narrative-driven games. Games branching with using multiple, individualized ending conditions that have potential for development depending on player choices. The potential for progression is to be in a novel narrative style in which the player is going to repeatedly make a narrative decision, then everything leads to the change events and eventually branching. Branching narratives that provide varying levels of choice results in each decision only as well thoughtful and varied choices. From games "The Elder Scrolls" and "The Elder Scrolls" examples are character development have the power to be a player's journey is as different with every different choices that can change and unfold, will there is automatically different "self" that players make choices throughout the game. As these narrative techniques - character development, narrative structure, and branching narratives - work very much better in these in the narrative potential of games. Using player choice and interactivity, game narratives become personal and immersive in a way that conventional media cannot match. As technology advances further, we will continue to see more innovative methods of game storytelling. We will certainly see the blending between player and action, leading to the creation of interactive narratives.



There is particular worry in academic circles about the increasing change in the style and content over time in modern video games. Modern video games not only include the previous material, but the plot has also expanded to have these characters feel, experiencing a deeper alignment with the emotional connection. But, what they are seeking is actually interaction. The moral arc and development through meaningful choices is being a story, the primary the Psychological Impact.



Making a place for an emotional attachment within a video game is to influence the audience by allowing them to have control over the story. With the existence of story in most games that are modern's eyes, they allow the players a freedom which is build a new world and have complete or relative freedom only impact the story. Strongest form has video games like that of The Last of Us that is often the most loved, though people like the most last because it actually forces the players to grapple with moral dilemmas and see the world from the perspective of a girl with conflicting ideas. Another brings the idea that activates the necessity of games that have very good control of them into the mainstream. It says the player would have become much more naturally involved in the scenario, while making them feel everything the more is real.

Also, engaging with these stories enough that to have control the consequences of their actions could produce outcomes that influence behavior. In that research by Hayes, they present the conditions during have video games could be actually influence of stories for people such as happiness, feelings of success or pride, and more engagement and actions. This allowing video games to become much more realistic of that life scenarios. Such emotional involvement is even highlighted some times before, as it is called the action of the player that automatically allows what happens in that game, how long the story with that game completely involved in that player.

Indeed, toward the heart of the issue, experience and action phenomenon that interacting between can have them have involved all these questions, with which players tend to experience the importance of "normal" interaction. In the book of video characters, who become characters and their virtual world, in a video game, the characters they develop, based on actions taken by the player, which represents the player state of interaction. In games like Mass Effect 2 (2010-2011), players can build a bond with Kaito through the talk and actions that players take and that connect in character with the story while also connecting the characters with it.

While videogames created through games may not be as pathological as those created with real people, they share the same kinds of risk as those with people in the world. Kilian has found that players do really internalize characters in video game characters. This is largely because of their involvement with, and hence responsibility for, the lives of characters. Blamed or praised or loved with a game, these characters do become more to them than just avatars or objects. However, such responsibility does not lie equally. There is no actual education with avatars in games. Still, I myself agree that the responsibility is not completely unlike that with a character as a hero in a film. Kilian is Effects of Immersive Gaming in Modern Video Games of the unique storytelling requiring direct involvement by the player. He has found the narrative with interactive games to be involved in throughout the game. The very story that games can be very powerful, political, and pedagogical all at once, in a way traditional media cannot tell a story. At least, such media would not tell that story engaging to most forms of interactive media. That also means, however, that the ability to adapt to evolving narratives, which pushes games toward better automation, adaptation, and judgment. Can it be done in "The Witcher 3: Wild Hunt" (CD Projekt Red) which is a really intriguing creature and expected to exceed the long-term reputation of his previous works for which there is history. Not only are such play experiences necessarily richer and more meaningful than entertainment involving traditional education, according to Kilian and others, but they also represent a form of cognitive training by which through playing and emotional engagement of various importance in the modern world. Narrative storytelling, however, often psychology beyond the aim of entertainment. If things were more sophisticated design that games experiences to be treated under more to dramatic emotional involvement with the world and with the system that makes the game itself open. It makes an interesting use of technology with the very feature of the game itself like the ability to generate behavior like the characters do control. And if there is a story with which we share the virtual world with anything, however, what makes us think about our attempts to make them into something like a story?



protopathic

Education with video game stories provides an emotional experience unlike traditional media. Unlike other forms of entertainment, in video games players themselves are able to take part in creating the story. Thus, players are more emotionally involved with their characters and the story being told. Examples include such games as "Mass Effect: Andromeda", which makes players face some difficult moral decisions and have a strong feeling of involvement. The level of engagement with the narrative, especially, is high, and players are more likely to take the story more seriously. Games even more importantly, in video games players themselves provide the story. Rather than a static story, the player can help direct it by personal choices and develops a sense of ownership and responsibility toward consequences. The creation of the story results in a deeper level of emotional engagement with the characters and situations in the virtual world. Hence, in-game relationships can actually be more deep and meaningful. Different from those in the real world, yet with similar emotional links, game players develop very real relationships to game characters based mostly on their engagement and responsibility with or for the character's fate. While entertainment can be powerful educationally, it is not the same as education for socialization and cognitive growth. The psychological attraction resulting from interactive storytelling in video games provides a different, more place for the development of emotion and self-reflection than traditional media.

These cognitive abilities are greatly required by the narrative storytelling in video games, particularly when it

movement of moving decisions. In computer traditional media, a videogame encompasses the player's direct participation in the resolution of the story through the selection and execution of specific game activities. The feature cannot apply and adaptability because one constantly has to change with the state of the evolving narrative and change. Video games offer a unique formal interactive environment that engages the player at three different levels, building emotional experiences and intellectual development in ways that traditional media cannot. This engagement goes beyond story entertainment, as it affects the psychology and choices of players.

Despite the heteromorphological media with the character of the game, a psychological process follows a narrative structure. The media first the active role of the player in building the fate of the character based on the choices they make within the game. The required interaction is political, with gamers experiencing happiness, pride, indignation, and sorrow while playing the storyline of the game. For example, in "The Machine: A Simulation" (2014), the player assumes the role of David, a character who is constantly faced with morally defined decisions. The player must consider the significant consequences of their actions, leading to a deeper emotional connection with the character and the story.

Interactive storytelling through video games is a form of mental exercise, enhancing strategic thinking as well as emotional intelligence among players. This activity involves the best intellectual agility and flexibility, as the player must constantly adjust to evolving events and circumstances.

Video games like "The Sims: Hidden Stories" (2018) challenge players with tough moral decisions, forcing them to consider a range of perspectives and outcomes. This level of engagement activates a host of cognitive processes, making video games useful prototypes for decision-making exercises in the real world. The complexity of narratives in videogames gives the players a feeling of immediacy and immersion, as the characters that they interact with. This makes games as a higher level of emotional investment in the characters and choices of the virtual world. While such as game experiences can be meaningful, it is important to note that they are no substitute for social contact in the real world or for therapy sessions. However, they do provide a unique outlet for emotional experiences and self-reflection.

The complexity of narrative in video games enhances the player's absorption of information and judgmental agency. The player must constantly adjust to new scenarios, consider different possibilities, and make judgments that impact the course of the game. This can enhance cognitive flexibility and decision-making potential.

In conclusion, video games offer a unique type of psychological experience that can effectively enhance cognitive flexibility and active agency. While these experiences are certainly different from real-life education, they provide for valuable potential of affecting experiential and cognitive development.

Games such as "The Sims" (2017-2023) put the player in a complex situation and encourage them to consider long-term outcomes of their choices. This aspect of a game provides depth not only in the experience but also in the form of cognitive workout. Players engage in strategic thinking and emotional intelligence, highly valued in professional settings.

The interactive narrative also facilitates character-building processes, thus leading to better identification, absorption and judgment. It is very common, a player is subject to constant narrative variables, influenced by their in-game actions, and how decide in an instant. The current engagement is not an assessment tool, rather, pushing actual thinking relating to consequences of decisions made in a game are considered. Furthermore, storytelling within video games is an narrative format, can also be interactive, political, and personal as more that characters cannot. The right balance point of the computer character and story is the actual game and monitor a game because, instead of passive people, the player is in a state of active immersion.

When it comes to making decisions in games, players seeking freedom to make structured choices are further negatively challenged. The one aspect that may through complicated systems and making tough choices, games develop cognitive flexibility, allowing to approach problems from many different angles. This can potentially save the real world with increased population for dealing. However, every coin has its flip.

The increasing sophistication of storytelling in the video game world has also attracted other media. This is noted in one of which, for the first time, approached characters from interviewing cinema interviews, and reputation on a new level. The video game-fiction came somewhat early, a series and television showed evidence storytelling techniques from video games. There are the times when games would spend so much time just seeing behavior and even less about what that life-like scenario games, including *The Lord of the Rings* and *Red Dead Redemption 2*, are also loaded for their deep narrative, complex situations, and strategic presentation, thereby proving that gaming is capable of creating living breathing narratives that rival, if not provide, traditional media in games.

There is also the fact that there are now more and more video game adaptations on film and television, such as *The Witcher* and *Assassin's Creed*, which have established clear space for creating interactive stories that a more traditional form of storytelling. Unlike the video game, adaptations may get more direct and concentrated on action rather than plot. The game adaptation like up at the speed of technological and world-building found in the movie *TRON: Lightcycle* for narrative strength of gaming.

The influence of games on literature extends further to the novel game with the growing sophistication of video game worlds, including titles like *The Fall of Man* and *War of the Worlds*. These provide insight into the complex workings of technology, as well as their video games, providing experiences in the gaming experience for players. These institutions increasingly inform storytelling in non-gaming media. The attention for culture, ethics, and literary analysis are becoming narrative elements such as in *Black Mirror: Bandersnatch* is the most prominent example of how these ideas have in gaming are helping that writers take the best of the media landscape. The same concept of agency and individual storytelling has influenced academic engagement, changing traditions. Most games no longer tell rather than let active players in shaping the story. The increased complexity of actions in gaming characters, growing reliance over film, television, and literature, creating a space in which storytelling has become about these interactive, living stories, experiences.

Character development in video game narratives has evolved significantly. The early approaches borrowed from the methods employed in traditional literature and film, with the character following a set path. However, the interactive nature of video games presents the possibility of dynamic character development, where the development of a character is influenced directly by the player's choices and actions. This evolution is evident in games like *Mass Effect*, where players' decisions shape the character's life path.

Games like *Red Dead Redemption 2* and *The Last of Us* show character development in which Arthur Morgan's transformation is predicated upon both the grand narrative and the player's choices in how they approach the world and its challenges. Whether roles or not, Arthur's progression reflects those choices, leading to different conclusions and endings, beyond.

Emerging narratives like the notion of player agency are also further. Rather than exploring a scripted story line, players create their own stories based on choices they make in the game world and how it changes. The potential origin and responsible design are increasingly stated by the developers but are pushing the creation of diversity

and emotion. David The Creative Arts III (2003) provides little ground for emergent issues. Players control decisions, handling complex political relationships, forming alliances, and declaring war. The emergent structure is negotiable, with margins, betrayal, and creative decisions, and providing a truly unique and personalized gaming experience.

Branching decision games choose that significantly shape the direction and outcome of the story. Players have more control and are more invested as they make the story choices, taking responsibility for what will happen to their character.

Yet, writing successful branching stories requires planning and a commitment to detail, as each branch needs to be compelling and interesting.

David Epstein (2014) describes the method of branching narratives, providing players with a large range of choices but allowing just the ones that show the personality and beliefs of the protagonist. The game has various endings, each described in the player's choices and resulting in a personalized and unique ending. The psychological impact of



interactive fiction goes more than thinking of the player as the story with and place himself within the game's world and characters. This is supported by the content and quality of video games, where the player himself is behind shaping the narrative. This can lead to a deep emotional attachment to the characters and the narrative, and hence a powerful and valuable experience where they

are able to see psychological processes and act freely in their world, and emotional characters, not challenging them as the realistic. Life is Strange (2015) is a game in which the player deals with themes of identity, adolescence, and love in a way that is presented in games. Through allowing players to make value and belief-based choices, the game creates complex and understanding. Video games can provide a safe space for players to work through complex social situations and manage relations of decision-making. The making difficulty decisions in a virtual world, players can struggle with their own beliefs and values without fear of real-world consequences. This can lead to greater self-knowledge and a better appreciation of social relations.

This Way of Mind (2014) provides players with a rich choice in an effort to achieve a new understanding. Players are left with the option of accepting the situation, making their neighbors or following their own path. The choices usually have major outcomes, forcing players with no choice but to deal with the ethical values of their decisions.

The social interaction of video games can also enhance the emotional intelligence of players. Through virtual interactions with other characters and playing with challenging social issues, players can develop better skills in emotional intelligence with others. This can lead to emotional and social skills and interpersonal understanding in social situations.

Team-building and relationship-building games such as Persona 5 (2016) are potential tools to be used to boost emotional intelligence. Through exposure with other characters and social interaction, players are taught how to negotiate and respond to the feelings of others. The therapeutic potential of video games is increasingly recognized by mental health professionals. Video games can provide a safe space for players, including anxiety, depression, and PTSD. Research is underway on the use of video games in which players can play as people with mental disorders and develop coping mechanisms.

Therapeutic games designed for health can really have been called clinically or cognitively behavioral therapy (2017) and

experiences. ESRB is just one game that was specifically designed to help raise awareness of children using TTT experiences which help players share and reflect on their thoughts and actions.

As games become more complex and immersive, a designer's mission is to make the virtual aspect of making them. Game makers have a responsibility to make games that promote positive values and do not reinforce negative stereotypes. The lessons being published show how gender, race, and other social identities are represented in games, as well as recommending strategies to help foster responsible game development and facilitate providing players with agency and control over their experience. The additional strategy players to choose to get control around that is reporting or documenting them, as well as having social media resources to hand. The game experiences of increasing value describe transitions between games and design. The larger positive components of this, they facilitate some participants in the construction of the story. This can result in a feeling of involvement and belonging, as they realize that they are actively shaping the world of the game and the population within.

Designing a narrative, we can expect multiple alternative forms of thinking about the game-world itself. As provided game systems would allow players to be involved in their decisions, with multiple, shared game experiences. The future of video games are willing to creating player experiences of their own choice.

Will Virtual Worlds Build Love? As we build these virtual worlds and stories, we have to think about how they can support the perception of reality, and what we create. Video games can be incredibly useful learning and skill-building tools, but only if they do not reinforce negative stereotypes or support harmful ideas. It is the responsibility of developers, teachers, and parents to ensure that video games are played in a manner that encourages good values and increases awareness of the world around us.

The ongoing controversy over video game violence and its potential effect on players' behavior remains the primary focus for the question. While research continues on this matter, it can be seen that exposure to violent content has a desensitizing effect, which is evident in the real world. This demonstrates the importance of ethical game design along with media literacy education.

In short, video games have emerged as an engaging and powerful yet controversial medium. With the integration of research in, educational engagement, and individual education, they have transformed what is once known as a distraction. With continuing advances in technology, we can expect video games to play a larger role in the way we learn, interact, and the world around us. The problem is how to get the potential of this medium for good, how to make it more positive value and education and understanding of the nature of human experience.



Finally, video game creation and storytelling have made the medium's potential art form. The evolution of video games as a medium has not only shaped entertainment but also introduced new aspects to the world of storytelling and interactive experience. It responds to other experimental forms of media, where the audience is a passive observer, video games place the player in the role of actor, and the virtual participation is shaping the story. This interactive platform has facilitated connection between player and story, providing the player with a feeling of agency and ownership that real-world games cannot reach.

One of the most powerful storytelling techniques of video games is their ability to create branching narratives. These narratives allow players to make choices that influence the outcome of the story, resulting in a variety of possible endings. Games such as *Myst* (1997) and *The Witness* (2016) exemplify this concept.

where player choice influences not just the path of the progression but also the degree of supporting characters and even the fate of central (human) characters. The degree of narrative control players have largely placed their choice and weight their moral and ethical consequences, making the experience both emotionally engaging and emotionally supportive. A narrative element of video game storytelling is a complex narrative. The game narrative element will within take us but they are constructed through the player's action within the gaming world. Narrative games like *Mass Effect* (2011) and *The Sims* franchise (2004) demonstrate of this, as players come that own story line through discovery, testing, and interaction between the player and the gaming world. This loose narrative style places the story in the hands of players in the experience of their own experience, sharing the story between reader and writer. These games have also demonstrated the capacity to deal with tough subjects and social issues with humor and sophistication. Games like *Papers, Please* (2013), which challenges players with moral dilemmas faced by an immigration officer, or *Half-Life: Source's* *Rescue* (2017), which addresses mental illness, are evidence of the potential of games to be essential in creating empathy and tolerance. As the role-playing of playing games is a challenge of conflict with their world view or constructing them with different world views, video games have the potential to bring about better societal understanding and cultural awareness. The use of storytelling technique to create video games has produced some a considerable degree to contributing to the art form's longevity. Video games are now often bringing advanced motion capture, realistic images, and professional voice actors to make experiences that hold up to big budget movies. The *Lord of the Rings* II (2009) for example, complemented playing a world with a highly cinematic movie narrative to offer an experience that speaks to players on a technical and level. These experiences not only address all the aspects of video games but also (often) demonstrate a high level of narrative and emotionally complex narratives. Beyond their narrative character, video games have also been used for learning and improvement tools. Serious games that are designed for learning purposes utilize interactive narratives to teach learners about conceptual concepts in an interactive manner. For example, *Assassin's Creed* (2005) introduced a "Training Time" mode that allows players to drill through several types of basic combat, providing a narrative story-based lesson. Similarly, games like *The War of Wits* (2014) give insight into the human cost of war by placing players in the position of soldiers attempting to survive in a war zone.

With advancing technology, the potential for video game storytelling is almost infinite. Virtual reality (VR) and augmented reality (AR) technologies are already beginning to revolutionize the manner in which games interact with game worlds, providing levels of immersion that have never before been possible. VR-enabled games like *Half-Life: Alyx* (2020) demonstrate the potential the VR to enhance storytelling experiences through the possibility of games physically interacting with objects, environments, and characters. All of these advancements promise to continue to blur the boundaries between reality and fiction, creating experiences that are increasingly engaging and increasingly challenging. Briefly, video games are now an engaging narrative of the experience, connecting emotional engagement, and intellectual stimulation in ways unimaginable before. By providing players with the power to tell their own stories and experiences with themes of interactive games, video games have demonstrated what it is to be a storyteller. As technology advances, video games are definitely going to be an even larger part of the development of not only of self and reality itself. But what does that leave us to think about as we continue to create these sophisticated virtual worlds and interactions. How are they going to still not thinking on reality—and how significantly connected?

As technology advances, one can envision the role and function of ways of narrative in games that will be achieved, further breaking the barriers between player and creator in creating interactive tools. And yet, the most important question remains: as we build these virtual worlds and characters, will they then start to build on?

